**EW 18**

**100. ARTICLES**

**101. The DEFINITE ARTICLE (*le*, *la*, *l'*, *les*) MUST BE USED in the following cases:**

**a) in universal statements, to denote a category or type**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Lions are dangerous | : | *Les lions sont dangereux* |
| I like tea | : | *J'aime le thé* |

**b) with titles**

General de Gaulle : *le Général de Gaulle* Captain Scott : *le capitaine Scott*

**c) with proper names qualified by an adjective** poor Mary : *la pauvre Marie*

**d) parts of the body** You must distinguish between:

A Actions which one does to one's own body

i) simple movement of a part of one's body, when nothing else is involved

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| He opened his mouth | : | *Il a ouvert la bouche* |
| I raised my arm | : | *J'ai levé le bras* |

ii) action done by oneself to a part of one's own body requires that the verb become reflexive

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| She wiped her mouth | : | *Elle s'est essuyé_ la bouche* |
| They rubbed their eyes | : | *Ils se sont frotté_ les yeux* |

B Actions done to another person's body

iii) action done to another person requires an indirect object pronoun to show possessor **(me, te, lui, etc)**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| He seized her arm | : | *Il lui a saisi le bras* |
| The cat jumped onto my lap | : | *Le chat m'a sauté sur les genoux* |

**BUT the possessive adjective (mon, ma mes etc) is used**

i) when the part of the body stands as the subject

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| His feet were hurting him | : | *Ses pieds lui faisaient mal* |
| His face was quite red | : | *Son visage était tout rouge* |

ii) when the part of the body is qualified by an adjective

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| I raised my hairy arm | : | *J'ai levé mon bras poilu* |

**e) "From" with countries**

If the country is masculine use *du / des* *Il est revenu du Japon / du Canada / des Etats-Unis*



**You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW**

BUT if the country is feminine use *de* — *Il est revenu de Suisse / d'Angleterre / de Belgique* (no article)

**f) in translations of *with* in descriptive phrases**

i) where it is a question of a PERMANENT FEATURE or AN ARTICLE OF DRESS use *à* + definite article (*au, à la, à l', aux*)

| | |
|---|---|
| The woman with the red hat | *La femme au chapeau rouge* |
| The boy with blond hair | *Le garçon aux cheveux blonds* |

ii) where it is a question of a TEMPORARY STATE the definite article stands alone (NO *avec*; NO *à*)

| | |
|---|---|
| He came in with his hands behind his back | *Il est entré les mains derrière le dos.* |

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**102. The DEFINITE ARTICLE is NOT USED in the following cases.**
(In each case note carefully the exception)

a) **with verbs and adjectives that ALWAYS REQUIRE `de' before a following noun**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| He did without wine | *Il s'est passé **de** vin* | covered in snow | *couvert **de** neige* |
| I need money | *j'ai besoin **d**'argent* | littered with books | *encombré **de** livres* |

BUT if English has `**the**', use one of **du, de la, de l', des**

| | |
|---|---|
| The table was littered with the books he had left there | *La table était encombrée des livres qu'il y avait laissés.* |
| He did without the wine we had bought him | *Il s'est passé du vin que nous lui avions acheté* |
| I need the money I lent you | *J'ai besoin de l'argent que je t'ai prêté* |

b) **with languages when used after *en* or with *parler***

| | |
|---|---|
| We speak German | *Nous parlons allemand* |
| He wrote in Chinese | *Il a écrit en chinois* |

BUT if *parler* is qualified by an adverb or adverbial phrase, or if the language is used with any verb other than *parler*, you must use a definite article

| | |
|---|---|
| We are learning Spanish | *Nous apprenons l'espagnol* |
| I am studying Greek | *J'étudie le grec* |
| He speaks Italian fluently | *Il parle couramment l'italien* |

c) **expressions of quantity are followed by `de' WITHOUT ARTICLE**

| | |
|---|---|
| He drank four cups of tea / a lot of wine | *Il a bu quatre tasses de thé / beaucoup de vin* |

BUT where English has `of the' use one of *du, de la, de l', des*

| | |
|---|---|
| He drank four cups of the tea I had bought | *Il a bu quatre tasses du thé que j'avais acheté* |



**You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW**

They drank a lot of the wine Paul had given us — *Ils ont bu beaucoup <u>du</u> vin que Paul nous avait donné*

d) **<u>The following expressions of quantity are always followed by one of *du, de la, de l', des*</u>**

(some) more **encore du/de la/des** — many **bien des + plural verb**
most **la plupart des + plural noun + plural verb**

Would you like some more wine? — *Vous voulez encore du vin?*
Most people never go there — *La plupart des gens n'y vont jamais*

e) **<u>with days of the week the definite article is not used</u>**

Monday is the first day of the week — *Lundi est le premier jour de la semaine*
We played cards on Thursday (evening) — *Nous avons joué aux cartes jeudi (soir)*

<u>BUT to translate "on" followed by a day of the week in the plural use *le*</u>

We play cards on Thursdays — *Nous jouons aux cartes <u>le</u> jeudi*
I used to see him on Tuesday mornings — *Je le voyais <u>le</u> mardi matin*

f) **<u>to translate "the more . . . the more" or "the less . . . the less"</u>** <u>do not use the definite article</u>

The more I see him the less I like him — *Plus je le vois, moins je l'aime*
The more you read the wiser you are — *Plus on lit plus on est sage*

g) **<u>no definite article is included with adjectival phrases</u>**

i) indicating <u>season</u> / <u>month</u>
On a winter's day — *par un jour <u>d'</u>hiver*
One autumn evening — *par un soir d'automne*

ii) indicating <u>type</u>
A French lesson — *une leçon <u>de</u> français*

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**103. <u>The INDEFINITE ARTICLE (*un, une, des*) is used as in English, but it is omitted in the following cases</u>:**

NOTE THAT THESE EXPLANATIONS IN THIS SECTION REFER ONLY TO THE INDEFINITE ARTICLE; IF THE ENGLISH HAD CONTAINED "THE" A DEFINITE ARTICLE WOULD BE USED.

a) **<u>with occupations, nationalities and religions</u>** <u>omit the indefinite article after *être* and *devenir*</u>

His father became a Catholic — *Son père est devenu catholique*
His brother is a doctor — *Son frère est médecin*
My teacher is a Frenchman — *Mon professeur est français*

<u>BUT if the occupation or religion is qualified by an adjective the article must be included</u>

His father became a good Catholic — *Son père est devenu un bon catholique*
His brother is a famous doctor — *Son frère est un médecin connu*



**You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW**

b) **Without any / a . . . & Without . . . or . . .** do not use an indefinite article

| | |
|---|---|
| He arrived without a coat | *Il est arrivé sans manteau* |
| He left for Germany without luggage or money | *Il est parti pour l'Allemagne sans bagages ni argent* |

c) **With/Without + abstract noun** **Avec / Sans** without indefinite article

| | |
|---|---|
| They waited impatiently | *Ils ont attendu avec impatience* |
| They spoke without conviction | *Ils ont parlé sans conviction* |

BUT, after **avec** & **sans**, if the abstract noun is qualified by an adjective, the indefinite article must be used

| | |
|---|---|
| He showed great courage | *Il a fait preuve d'un grand courage* |

d) **As a . . .** **Comme** without an indefinite article

| | |
|---|---|
| As a student he is very gifted | *Comme étudiant il est très doué* |
| He works as a hairdresser | *Il travaille comme coiffeur* |

g) **When a noun is in apposition** the INDEFINITE article is omitted

| | |
|---|---|
| Manchester, a large industrial town | *Manchester, grande ville industrielle* |
| Louis Lumière, a chemist from Lyon | *Louis Lumière, chimiste de Lyon* |

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**104. *des* will always shorten to *de* when it comes immediately before a plural adjective**, unless *des* means "of the"

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| *des hommes* | BUT | **de beaux hommes** |
| *j'en ai un autre* | BUT | **j'en ai d'autres** |
| *des filles* | BUT | **de jolies filles** |

BUT *beaucoup des jolies filles* because the meaning is "a lot of the pretty girls"

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**105. *du, de la, de l', des* will always shorten to *de* after a negative if it expresses absence or lack**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| *J'ai bu de la bière* | BUT | *je n'ai pas bu de bière* |
| *J'ai un stylo* | BUT | *je n'ai pas de stylo* |

NOTE
- *ne . . . que* is not a true negative — *je n'ai bu que de la bière*
- if the sentence using a negative does not express absence or lack, do not use *de*

| | |
|---|---|
| This is not a pipe | *Ceci n'est pas une pipe* (Magritte) |
| They were not Germans | *Ce n'étaient pas des Allemands* |



**You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW**